The Rebook Script

What to say so clients book their next appointment before they leave the chair.

A Miko Pierson playbook · Bigger Than Shears™

A beautiful hairstyle does not automatically create a returning client.

Clients leave because the consultation felt rushed, the experience lacked personal attention, maintenance was never explained — or simply because nobody asked. The industry average rebooking rate is around 10%. Salons that change what the stylist says at the chair report 75%. The service didn't change. The sentence did.

Why "Would you like to book?" fails

"Would you like to book your next appointment?" is a question that invites the answer *no* — or worse, *"I'll call you."* I'll-call-you is not a commitment; it's an exit. When the next appointment is made before they leave, it creates the appointment itself — and an appointment is a real commitment people keep, far more reliably than a promise to call back. (Field research on commitment shows a scheduled appointment more than doubles follow-through versus good intentions.)

The fix is not pressure. It's a prescription.

The Script

Say what their hair needs — like you would describe any maintenance plan. Confident, specific, matter-of-fact.

The maintenance script (default):

> *"This cut needs to be refreshed every four weeks to hold the shape. I've got Thursday the 18th or Saturday the 20th — which one holds for you?"*

The growth-out script (for color or a style in transition):

> *"In about six weeks this will start growing past the shape — let's get your next visit on the books now so you're not fighting it later."*

The standing-slot script (for your regulars):

> *"Same time, five weeks from now? I'll hold your spot."*

Notice what all three do: they tell the client what the hair needs, they name a window, and they offer a choice between yeses. None of them ask permission to do their job.

The three rules

1. **Prescribe, don't ask.** "I need to see you in six weeks" beats "want to rebook?" — every time. You are the professional; the maintenance plan is yours to state.
2. **Do it at the chair, not the checkout.** The conversation happens while the cape is still on — where the hair is the subject. By the time they're at the desk, the moment is gone.
3. **Give two options, never one.** "Thursday or Saturday" keeps them choosing between slots — not between booking and leaving.

The number worth knowing

Loyal clients are the base that pays — industry platform data shows roughly 42% of loyal clients drive about 80% of a salon's revenue, and keeping a client costs a fraction of finding a new one. Every client who leaves without a next appointment is a re-acquisition cost you haven't felt yet.

Check your own number: the share of clients who leave with their next visit booked is your rebooking rate. If it isn't tracked, it isn't managed.

Retention begins before the service is finished. What is your chair actually saying?

Sources: John Harms interview, *American Salon* (10% vs 75% rebooking, prescriptive language); Zenoti beauty & wellness platform data (42%/80% loyalty concentration); Gine, Karlan et al., "Appointments: A More Effective Commitment Device" (appointment-as-commitment field experiment); Phorest rebooking-rate KPI definition. Platform statistics are vendor-published figures — directionally consistent across providers, not peer-reviewed.